CHEAT SHEET

Who is leaving, and at which step?

Zomato Gold, Chennai, Week 4 Thursday. Month-two retention read flat at 38 percent from June to September 2026 while every cohort fell, and members' Android add-to-cart to order fell from 58 to 44 percent after the 14 September release. Illustrative case: the company is real, the situation and the data are synthetic. The gym and the college are invented.

C2_W04_D04_beyond_the_blend_STUDENT
Verified 13 October 2026
6 panels, 2 diagrams

1 Cohort construction: what does the triangle say?

	members	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Jan	4,854	58	38.7	38.4	38.1	37.8	37.5	37.2	36.9
Feb	5,055	56	38.6	38.3	38.0	37.7	37.4	37.1	
Mar	5,449	55	38.6	38.4	38.0	37.8	37.5		
Apr	4,859	53	38.6	38.3	38.0	37.7			
May	4,905	52	38.7	38.4	38.1				
Jun	4,821	50	38.9	38.6					
Jul	5,057	49	38.5						
Aug	13,000	31							

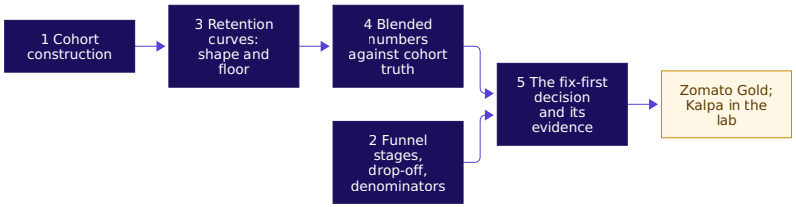
months since joining run across; month one is the solid column, August's in rose, not yet counted by the dashboard; each cell is the percent of the cohort who ordered

Read	What it shows	On the case
Across a row	How a cohort's members leave	Down to about 38.5 in month two, then 0.3 points a month
Down column one	How each cohort starts	58 for January, 49 for July, 31 for August
The grid underneath	One row per member per month, 1 if she ordered (panel data)	241,492 member-months, grouped by joining month and age

`retention(c, k) = members of c active at age k / members of c`; the joining month is age zero and is never counted.

Crux. Fix each member's joining month and count her age from it; compare cohorts at the same age, and read one calendar month across them only to look for a shock that hit everyone.

2 How do the five topics connect?



Crux. A cohort fixes the entry moment. A curve's floor, by our rule, is read only once two ages agree within a point. A blend is a size-weighted average and counts who it counts. Each funnel step divides by the step before, in one named unit. When the overall falls, the step that moved owns the fall, and a fix-first call carries its comparator, its date and its cost.

3 Retention curves and blended numbers: where is the floor?

Idea	The gym (invented)	Gold
Floor: two ages within a point	January 80, 60, 50, 50, 50	38.5, eroding 0.3 a month
Blend: size-weighted average	100 at 40, 400 at 52.5: 250 of 500	13,218 of 35,000
Plain mean: one vote a cohort	46.25 against 50	36.9 against 35.9

`blend = sum of (cohort size x cohort rate) / sum of cohort sizes`

Crux. Rebuilt from its cohorts, a blend lands on the direct count; rank cohorts at the same age.

4 Funnel stages, drop-off, denominators: how does a step read?

Step, September, Gold members	Per session	Per member
Search to menu view	118 percent	101 percent
Menu view to add-to-cart	34 percent	61 percent

`step rate = this step / the step before, in one unit`; drop-off = 100 less it; overall = last / first.

Crux. Here, above 100 is a step members skip; of sessions that searched, 89 percent opened a menu.

5 The fix-first decision and its evidence: what goes first?

Causes in order: tracking, the definition, cohorts, everyone, a stage. The page: call, evidence, cost ranged, objection, what would change it.

Crux. Rule out the count and the rule first, then fix the step that moved before the step that is low.

6 The case in numbers: what is fixed first?

Line	On the case
Twelve members, by age	May 3, 2, 1, 1 of 4; June 2, 1, 1 of 3; August sale 0 of 5
The step	Checkout start to order, 72.5 to 55 percent, Android members, from 14 September
The comparators	On the same step: iOS members 71 to 70, non-members on Android 65 to 64
The size	About 1,133 to 1,317 orders a week; Rs 3.4 to 6.6 lakh of order value

Crux. The checkout first, since it loses orders weekly; then the sale-week payback, 20 against 49.

THE WORDS ON THIS SHEET

Cohort Members who joined in the same calendar month

Age, month zero Months since joining; the joining month is age zero and is never counted

Cohort table Joining months down the side, ages across, each cell over the whole cohort

Retention curve One cohort's share active at each age

Floor Where a curve stops falling: two ages within a point, by our rule

Churn The share lost, so far or since the month before